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Consultants

■ MAMMALS

Professor David Macdonald CBE is a leading world authority on mammals, and is founder and Director of the Wildlife Conservation Research Unit at Oxford University, UK. Aside from his many scientific publications, he is known for his prize-winning books and films, such as *Meerkats United*.

■ BIRDS

David Burnie studied Zoology at Bristol University, UK, and has contributed to nearly 150 books on animals and the environment. He is a Fellow of the Zoological Society of London.

■ REPTILES

Dr. Colin McCarthy is a scientific associate of the Life Sciences Department, and formerly Collection Manager of Reptiles, Amphibians, and Fish, at the Natural History Museum, London, UK.

■ AMPHIBIANS

Professor Tim Halliday retired as Professor of Biology at the Open University in 2009 but continues to pursue his interest in the reproductive biology of amphibians.

■ INVERTEBRATES

Dr. George C. McGavin is a zoologist, author, explorer, and television host. He is an Honorary Research Associate of the Oxford University Museum of Natural History and a Research Associate of the Department of Zoology at Oxford University, UK. His TV credits include *Expedition Borneo*, *Lost Land of the Jaguar*, *Lost Land of the Tiger*, and *Monkey Planet*.

■ GENERAL CONSULTANT

Dr. Kim Dennis-Bryan is a paleontologist who worked at the Natural History Museum, London, before becoming an associate lecturer in life and environmental sciences at the Open University, UK.

■ EDITORIAL CONSULTANT

Dr. Don E. Wilson is Curator Emeritus, Vertebrate Zoology, National Museum of Natural History, Smithsonian. He is the author of more than 250 scientific publications and 25 books on a variety of topics, including the mammals of North America, bats, humans, biodiversity, and mammal species of the world. He is an elected Fellow of the AAAS, and Honorary member of ASM.

Contributors

Jamie Ambrose is a UK-based American author, editor, and journalist with a special interest in the natural world.

Richard Beatty (glossary writer) is a writer and editor based in Edinburgh, UK.

Dr. Amy-Jane Beer is a biologist, nature writer, and editor of the UK charity PTES (People's Trust for Endangered Species) *Wildlife World* magazine.

Derek Harvey is a naturalist with particular interests in evolutionary biology, and writer for titles that include DK's *Science* and *The Natural History Book*.

Ben Hoare is features editor of *BBC Wildlife* magazine, UK.

Rob Hume is a natural history writer and editor with a lifetime interest in wildlife, especially birds. He is author of more than 20 books, including DK's *Bird*, and *Birds of Europe and North America*.

Tom Jackson is a zoologist and science writer based in Bristol, UK.

Steve Parker has a zoology degree and has written more than 200 books and websites on nature, ecology, conservation, and evolution.

Dr. Katie Parsons has a PhD in animal behavior and ecology. She is currently a freelance natural history writer and conservation consultant.

John Woodward has written more than 40 books and many hundreds of articles on all aspects of the natural world.

Smithsonian

Established in 1846, the Smithsonian—the world's largest museum and research complex—includes 19 museums and galleries and the National Zoological Park. The total number of artifacts, works of art, and specimens in the Smithsonian's collections is estimated at 138 million, the bulk of which is contained in the National Museum of Natural History, which holds more than 126 million specimens and objects. The Smithsonian is a renowned research center, dedicated to public education, national service, and scholarship in the arts, sciences, and history.